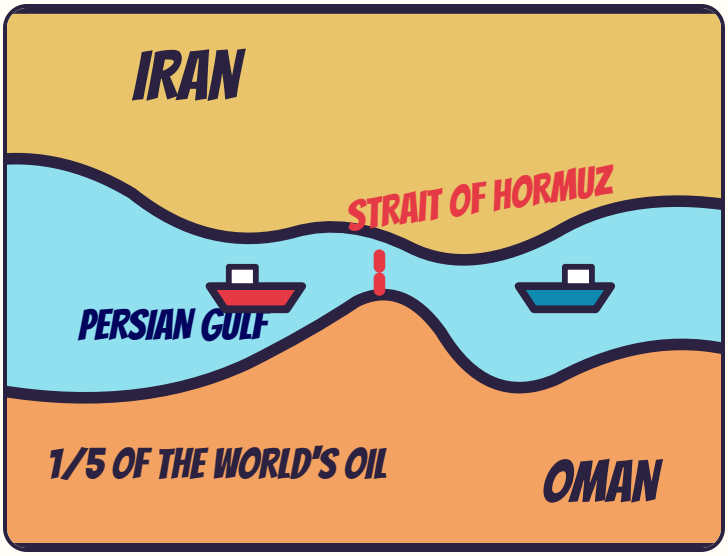
THE WEEKLY EXPLORER

All the news that's fit to know, for curious minds

Week of October 12, 2026 · Your Town · 12 pages



TOP STORY

A war far away, felt at every gas pump

The war between the US and Israel on one side and Iran on the other is in its **eighth month**. Iran has been attacking oil tankers near the **Strait of Hormuz**, a narrow sea lane that normally carries about a fifth of the world's oil. Oil jumped to about **$105 a barrel** this week, up from $72 before the war, and US gas now averages about $4.37 a gallon, over a dollar more than a year ago.

Peace talks are stuck, but President Trump said the US won't attack Iran before the Nov 3 elections. Full story on page 2; what it does to prices on page 7.

THE WEEK IN 12 HEADLINES

- Russia hits buses in Ukraine; four countries propose a limited truce — P.2
- Brazil's election goes to a Lula vs Bolsonaro run-off — P.3
- Ebola reaches Kenya as Congo's outbreak becomes its worst ever — P.3
- Nobel prizes for brain light-switches, ghost particles and mirror molecules — P.4
- Starship reaches orbit; astronauts make a record-fast space trip — P.4
- A crocodile hiding in the Sphinx's rock, and 57 new deep-sea species — P.5
- GPT-6 arrives for 1.2 billion ChatGPT users — P.6
- Oil hits $105 and banks raise interest rates — P.7
- Haze pushes Singapore's air into the 'unhealthy' zone — P.8
- Chennai's new metro line opens Sunday — P.8
- Hurricane Isaias, the latest first hurricane in 121 years — P.9
- NEW: three puzzle pages and a 10-question quiz — P.10

WORD OF THE WEEK

INFLATION

(in-FLAY-shun) When the prices of most things keep rising, so the same money buys less. Costly oil and a weak monsoon push it up; central banks fight it by raising interest rates (page 7).

NAME THIS PAPER!

Still taking entries! Write your best name here:

_____

_____

JOKE!

Why did the neutrino skip the party?

It went straight through without stopping to say hello. (Turn to page 4 to get it.)



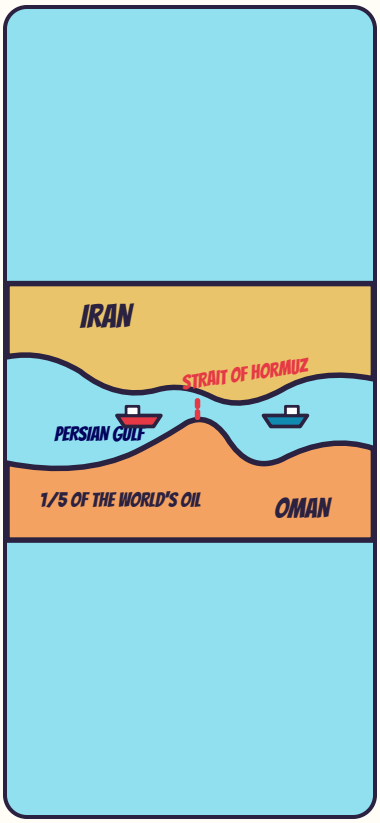
SCOOP

Scoop here! Stories with a QR code have more to read: scan them with a tablet or phone.

Three whole pages of puzzles at the back. Save them for last!



PROF. HOOT



MIDDLE EAST

The Iran war enters its eighth month

READ MORE

On Feb 28 the US and Israel launched airstrikes on Iran, killing its supreme leader. Iran hit back at Israel and at US bases, and blocked the **Strait of Hormuz**. Since April the US Navy has blockaded Iran's ports to stop its oil sales, which bring in most of Iran's money.

Talks are stuck. Vice President **JD Vance** wants Iran to make a big cut to its uranium enrichment, while Iran's President **Masoud Pezeshkian** called negotiations "futile". Iran's foreign minister says messages still pass through go-betweens. On Oct 8 President Trump said the US would not attack Iran before the Nov 3 midterm elections.

Meanwhile ships keep getting attacked near Hormuz: 9 attacks in October by Oct 7. A US government report says the war had cost about **$38 billion** by August.

EXPLAINER: 4 WORDS

- **Strait of Hormuz:** the only sea exit from the Persian Gulf, between Iran and Oman. About 125 big ships a day used it before the war.
- **Uranium enrichment:** raising the share of a special kind of uranium atom. Power plants need about 3-5%; a bomb needs about 90%. Iran has reached 60%.
- **Blockade:** using warships to stop ships going in or out of a country's ports.
- **Ceasefire vs peace deal:** a ceasefire stops the shooting for now; a peace deal settles the argument behind it. A ceasefire in April broke down.

UKRAINE

Truce ideas arrive as attacks on transport grow

READ MORE

Russia invaded Ukraine in February 2022, and the war is in its fifth year. On Oct 8 a Russian glide bomb struck two passenger buses in Kramatorsk, killing at least 30 people. Experts say Russia is now targeting Ukraine's transport: at least 521 train engines have been hit since 2022. The UN says civilian casualties in 2026 are 55% higher than last year.

India, Turkiye, Egypt and the US have each sent truce proposals. None would end the war; they aim to stop attacks on power plants and ports and keep grain ships safe. Russia still demands four Ukrainian regions.

GAZA

Three years since October 7

On Oct 7, 2023, Hamas-led fighters attacked southern Israel, killing 1,139 people and taking about 240 hostages. Israel's war in Gaza followed.

Gaza's health ministry says at least **74,000** Palestinians have been killed, including 21,000 children, and about 90% of people have been forced from their homes. UN figures say only 42 of 666 health centres work.

A ceasefire began on Oct 10, 2025. The US says it is holding, but Israeli strikes have continued on most days, and Israel and Hamas each blame the other. Israel holds an election on **Oct 27**.

AROUND THE WORLD IN BRIEF

- **Yemen:** Fighting is the worst since a 2022 truce. Houthi rebels seized the whole Red Sea coast; more than 200,000 people have fled their homes, and Houthi missiles hit two Saudi airports.
- **Sudan:** Army chief Abdel Fattah al-Burhan rejected peace talks with the RSF militia. The war since 2023 has forced about 13 million people from their homes, one of the world's worst crises.
- **Ethiopia and Eritrea:** The neighbours cut diplomatic ties as fighting returned to Tigray. Ethiopia, which has no coast, says it must have access to the Red Sea.
- **Mali:** The army, helped by Russian fighters, retook the desert city of Kidal from rebels.



PROF. HOOT

Hard news, told straight. Talk about it with a grown-up!



BRAZIL

Brazil heads to a run-off: Lula vs Bolsonaro

Brazil, South America's biggest country with 214 million people, voted for president on Oct 4. To win outright you need more than half the votes. Nobody did, so the top two face a **run-off on Oct 25**.

READ MORE

Senator **Flavio Bolsonaro**, 45, came first with about 47.5%. President **Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva**, 80, got about 44.7%. Flavio is the eldest son of former president Jair Bolsonaro, whom Lula beat in 2022. Voters said the biggest issues are the cost of living, corruption and crime.

HEALTH

Ebola reaches Kenya

Ebola is a dangerous virus spread through the body fluids of sick people or animals. An outbreak in the **Democratic Republic of Congo** since May has about 8,300 cases and more than 4,100 deaths, the worst in Congo's history.

READ MORE

On Oct 6 Kenya reported its first death: a man who travelled from Congo through Uganda and flew to Nairobi. Officials are tracking everyone he met, plus the 27 people on his flight, for 21 days.

This strain, called Bundibugyo, has **no vaccine** yet. The WHO says the epidemic is "far from over".

CLIMATE

Switzerland lost a fifth of its ice

Swiss glaciers lost 5.5% of their ice this year and almost **20% since 2021**, after the hottest Swiss summer on record. Scientists blame human-caused climate change.

ARCTIC

Arctic ice hits a low

Sea ice at the top of the world shrank to about **4.6 million sq km** on Sept 12, tied for 10th-lowest since satellites began. Scientists project ice-free Arctic summers before about 2050.

NOBEL: LITERATURE

A poet of ancient Greece wins

Canadian **Anne Carson**, 76, is a poet and a professor of ancient Greek and Latin. She mixes poems, essays and stories, and writes fresh versions of Greek plays. Told she'd won, she said: "Crazy. I think they're all crazy."

EARTH CHECK-UP

7 of 9 safe limits crossed

Scientists track nine "planetary boundaries" that keep Earth stable. Seven are now crossed, including climate, fresh water, plastics and wildlife. Only the ozone layer and air particles are still safe.

OZONE

A big ozone hole, but healing

The hole over Antarctica grew to the 2nd-largest for this time of year. The cause was very cold air, not new pollution; harmful CFCs were banned in 1989 and the layer is still slowly recovering.

THE HAGUE

Ex-leader must face trial

The **International Criminal Court** ruled that former Philippine President Rodrigo Duterte, 81, is fit to stand trial. He is accused of crimes against humanity over thousands of killings in his "war on drugs" (2016-2022), which he denies. His trial opens Nov 30. The ICC tries people, not countries.

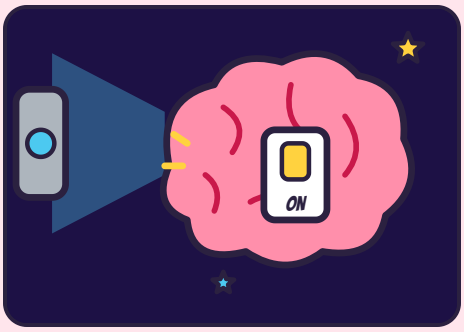


SCOOP

A run-off is a second round when nobody wins half the votes.

ALSO THIS WEEK

- **Nobel Peace Prize:** Announced in Oslo on Friday, Oct 9, as we went to print. Find out who won; we'll report next week.
- **Israel and the UK:** Israel ordered Britain's consulate in East Jerusalem shut, angry over UK sanctions on settlers.
- **EU and China:** Tense trade talks in Beijing. Europe buys over a billion euros a day more from China than it sells there.
- **Australia:** The High Court blocked a coal mine's expansion because of its climate harm, a landmark ruling.

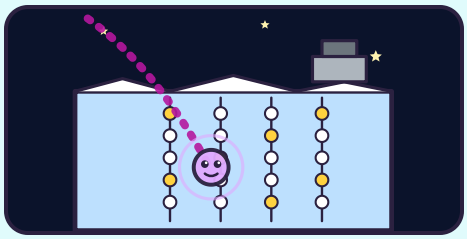


MEDICINE

A light switch for brain cells

Germans **Peter Hegemann** (71) and **Georg Nagel** (73) found a light-catching protein in a green pond alga that swims toward light. American **Karl Deisseroth** (54) put it into nerve cells in 2005: shine blue light, and the cell fires.

This "optogenetics" shows which brain cells control memory, fear and movement, and doctors are testing it to restore some sight.



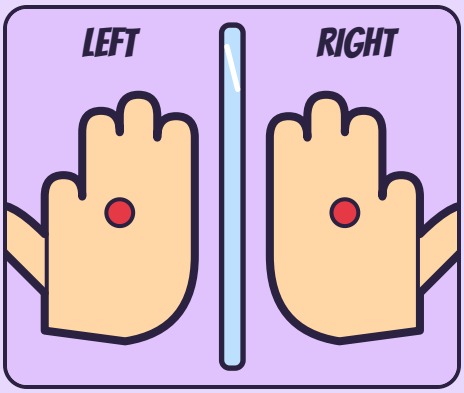
PHYSICS

Hunting ghost particles in ice

About 100 trillion **neutrinos** pass through you every second without touching anything. **Francis Halzen**, 82, had the idea of catching them in the deep ice at the South Pole.

READ MORE

IceCube has 5,160 sensors in a cubic kilometre of ice, and traced neutrinos to distant galaxies. He won alone, the first solo physics winner since 1992.

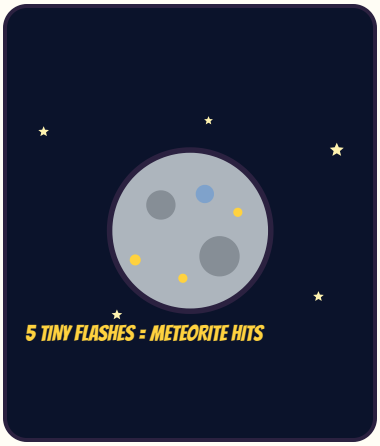


CHEMISTRY

Molecules that pick a hand

Many molecules come in left- and right-handed mirror forms, and life uses almost only one of each. **Henri Kagan**, 95 (France), and **Kenso Soai**, 76 (Japan), showed how a tiny head start for one hand gets copied and amplified.

It helps drugmakers make only the useful form of a medicine.



SPACE

What the Artemis II astronauts saw at the Moon

NASA published the science report from April's Artemis II flight around the Moon. The crew (Reid Wiseman, Victor Glover, Christina Koch and Canada's Jeremy Hansen) saw **five tiny flashes**: pebble-sized rocks smashing into the Moon, perhaps the faintest ever seen by eye. With the Sun hidden for 54 minutes, they saw its glowing corona.

READ MORE

ROCKETS

Starship reaches orbit at last

SpaceX's Starship, about 124 m tall and the most powerful rocket ever, reached orbit on Sept 28 and released 26 Starlink satellites. One engine failed, so the flight was cut short. NASA needs it as a Moon lander.

ASTRONOMY

A "phoenix planet"?

Astronomers may have found a Jupiter-like planet that formed from the leftovers of a **dead star**, a white dwarf. If confirmed, a star's death isn't the end for its planets.



BOLT

Neutrinos zoom through me too. Rude, honestly.

SCIENCE IN BRIEF

- **Speedy trip:** Crew-13 reached the space station in under 8 hours, the fastest US trip; Crew-12 splashed down after 8 months.
- **Mars mystery cloud:** A 1,800 km cloud that forms daily over a Martian volcano turns vapour straight into ice, never seen on any planet before.
- **Germs and cancer:** Infections cause about 1 in 8 cancers worldwide; many could be prevented with vaccines like HPV.
- **Rosalind Franklin:** Her notebooks suggest she spotted DNA's spiral shape before Watson and Crick.
- **Roman temple:** Archaeologists in Germany found a temple to Mars, god of war, beside a Roman fort.
- **Record radio flash:** The Webb telescope traced a radio burst to a galaxy over 10 billion light-years away.
- **RIP Margaret Hamilton (90):** She led the software that landed Apollo 11 on the Moon.



NEW SPECIES

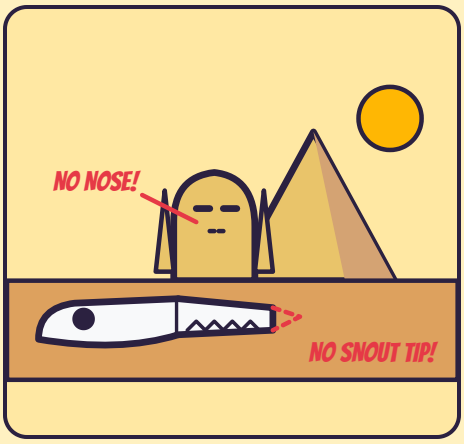
57 new species from a deep-sea canyon

57 NEW!

A robot sub called **SuBastian** explored the Mar del Plata Canyon off Argentina, which is over 3,500 m deep, almost twice as deep as the Grand Canyon. Twenty scientists then named **57 new species**: 20 tiny copepods, 22 sea cucumbers and sea lilies, 14 corals and a tusk-shell.

READ MORE

The star is **"Loki"**, a see-through sea cucumber with horn-like flaps, found 2,577 m down. Only about a tenth of the copepod samples have been checked, and every one so far was new to science.



FOSSILS

A crocodile hiding in the Sphinx's rock

A 45-million-year-old crocodile skull came from the same limestone used to build Egypt's **Great Sphinx**. It was dug up about a century ago and mislabelled, until a CT scan showed it was a new kind: **Herugavialis**, named after the god Heru.

Its snout tip is missing, just like the Sphinx is missing its nose! It belongs to the gavial family, whose only living relatives today are the long-snouted gharials of India.

ANIMALS

Jonathan, 194, gets his DNA read

The world's oldest land animal, a giant tortoise on St Helena island, has 287 special gene variants, many for repairing DNA. One expert joked: "Maybe Jonathan is just really good at being old."

NEAR YOU

New sea spiders in our own sea

Divers found two new **sea spiders** in the Salish Sea off Washington and BC, one with red eyes and hairy legs.

ANIMAL TALK

Decoding elephant choruses

Scientists used AI on 902 recordings of wild elephants in Kenya, collected since 1986. When families rumble together, the calls seem to carry who is calling and what the group is doing. The AI still made many mistakes, so it's early days.



If YOU named a deep-sea species, what would it be?

NATURE NOTES

- **Elvish coral:** A new golden deep-sea coral got a name in Tolkien's Elvish: Laurinque elenya, "of the stars".
- **Fat Bear Week:** Alaska's Backpack the brown bear (about 500 kg!) won the online vote with 103,344 votes.
- **Mystery viruses:** 99% of 11,742 viruses found in a deep-sea mining zone were new to science.
- **Bat-hunting crocs:** The world's smallest crocodiles were filmed catching bats in dark caves in Gabon.
- **Sycamore Gap:** England's famous tree, cut down in 2023, is sprouting again; 49 saplings from its seeds were planted.
- **Desert capybaras:** A 9-million-year-old tooth shows capybara relatives once lived in Chile's Atacama Desert.
- **Our orcas:** Only 76 southern resident orcas remain (page 9).



ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE CONFIRMED

GPT-6 arrives for everyone

OpenAI made **GPT-6** available to all ChatGPT users this week, which it says is more than **1.2 billion** people a week. Paying users get "GPT-6 Sol"; free users get "GPT-6 Luna".

READ MORE

A new feature lets answers include charts, buttons and little tools, like a calculator, right inside the chat. Chatbots are turning from text boxes into mini-apps.

Anthropic released **Claude Haiku 5.5**, a small fast model about 75% cheaper to run, and updated its rules to ban using Claude to interfere with elections.



GADGETS PART RUMOR

"Welcome home. October 13."

Confirmed: an Apple executive posted that teaser, so something is coming Tuesday. **Rumored only:** a smart-home hub with a 6-inch screen (about $350), a new HomePod mini and Apple TV. Apple hasn't said what it will show.

GOVERNMENT

A "Super Intelligence Force"

President Trump signed an order renaming "AI" as "Super Intelligence" in government work and created a four-person task force to keep the US ahead.

CYBERSECURITY

Hackers steal Denmark's ID list

Names, addresses and ID numbers in **8.8 million** records were stolen from Denmark's national register.

KIDS ONLINE ALLEGED

A safety button that didn't work?

New York says TikTok tested a "refresh my feed" button that, for thousands of users including kids, did nothing: a **placebo**. TikTok says it tests features like any company. A court will decide.

READ MORE

In Congress, both parties are edging toward the **Kids Online Safety Act**, which would make apps protect under-18s. Supporters include Apple; critics worry age checks hurt privacy.

NEWS DETECTIVE

- **RUMORED:** people are guessing.
- **REPORTED:** a journalist's sources say so. Often right, sometimes not.
- **ALLEGED:** someone accuses; not yet proven in court.
- **CONFIRMED / ANNOUNCED:** the company or officials say it themselves.
- Spot all four labels on this page!



New chatbots every week. Remember: always check what they tell you!

TECH IN BRIEF

Teen hacker arrested: Spanish police arrested a 16-year-old suspected of leading the KillSec ransomware gang, blamed for about 1,000 attacks.

Robotaxis: Waymo gives 500,000+ driverless rides a week and borrowed $5 billion to grow; Uber will test robotaxis in London.

Tesla: Delivered 486,532 electric cars in three months, more than expected but 2% fewer than a year ago.

MONEY

Why prices are rising, and what banks are doing about it

7



ENERGY

Oil hits $105: here's why your family pays more

On Oct 8, Brent crude (the world's main oil price) jumped about 5% to **$105 a barrel**. Two reasons: Iran attacked about a dozen tankers near Hormuz in a week, and a hurricane forced oil workers off rigs in the Gulf of Mexico.

READ MORE

US gas averaged about **$4.37 a gallon**, up from $3.13 a year ago. Oil isn't just petrol: it moves trucks, ships and planes, so when it costs more, food and nearly everything else costs more too. That's **inflation**.

MONEY WORDS

- **Interest rate:** the extra you pay to borrow money, or earn for saving it.
- **Central bank:** a country's bank for banks (the Fed in the US, the RBI in India). Raising rates makes borrowing dearer, so people spend less and prices cool.
- **Stock:** a tiny piece of a company you can buy. If people think the company will earn more, the price rises.
- **Trade deficit:** spending $10 on a friend's stickers but selling them only $4 of yours: a $6 deficit.

USA

The Fed may raise rates again

US inflation was **3.4%** in August, above the 2% goal. The Fed raised rates in September, and most officials expect another rise by year end.

TRADE

Trade gap grows anyway

The US bought **$105.6 billion** more from abroad than it sold in August, partly AI computers. Tariffs were meant to shrink this gap.

STOCKS

Records, then a wobble

US stocks hit record highs on Oct 6 on excitement about AI. Two days later tech stocks fell (the Nasdaq about 1.4%) after a report said OpenAI earns about **$50 billion** a year, not $70 billion. AI companies are valued on belief in huge future earnings, so doubts move prices fast.

KIDS & MONEY

Every US kid gets an investment account

The White House says every child with a Social Security number has been signed up for a **"Trump Account"**, over 60 million in all. Kids born 2025-2028 get $1,000 from the government; families can add up to $5,000 a year. The money is invested in the stock market and can't be taken out until age 18. Supporters say it teaches saving; the article quoted no critics, and the numbers hadn't been independently checked.

READ MORE



SCOOP

Ask a grown-up: what costs more now than last year?

MONEY IN BRIEF

- **India:** The RBI raised its interest rate to 5.50% (page 8). The rupee is weak, about 96 to the US dollar.
- **Gold:** About $4,187 an ounce, up 8% in a year. People buy gold when worried, and it makes Diwali jewellery pricier.
- **Jobs:** US employers added only 29,000 jobs in September; unemployment rose to 4.2% (page 10).

INDIA · CHENNAI

Chennai's new metro line opens Oct 11

The first stretch of **Chennai Metro Phase 2**, a 14.6 km elevated line from **Poonamallee to Vadapalani**, is due to open on Sunday, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi expected to ride it. Eleven of its 17 stations open first; trains come every 10 minutes and the full ride costs Rs 40.

READ MORE

The trains can drive themselves, but two operators will ride along until mid-2027. Phase 2 will eventually stretch 118.9 km, one of India's biggest metro projects.

SINGAPORE · HAZE

Haze makes the whole island's air unhealthy

On Oct 8 the 24-hour **PSI** (Pollutant Standards Index) passed 100, the "unhealthy" level, in all five regions of Singapore; the west hit 159. It's the first unhealthy haze since 2023.

READ MORE

The smoke comes from peat fires in **Sumatra and Kalimantan** in Indonesia, which had 1,201 fire hotspots on Oct 7. Peat can smoulder underground and flare up again. A strong El Niño means the dry season may last into November.

Children are told to keep outdoor activity to a minimum.

TAMIL NADU

First test for Vijay's TVK government

Madurantakam and Dharapuram voted Oct 6 after their MLAs left the AIADMK for Chief Minister **C. Joseph Vijay**'s TVK and stood again. Turnout hit 86%; counting was under way as we printed.

INDIA

Weakest monsoon since 2015

Rains were about **13% below normal**, blamed on a strong El Niño. Maharashtra declared drought in 265 areas.

SINGAPORE

Night race in the haze and heat

Marina Bay hosts its first **Sprint weekend**; the Grand Prix is Sunday at 8pm, 62 laps. Teen **Kimi Antonelli** (Mercedes) leads with 320 points, ahead of George Russell (236). Officials declared a "heat hazard" race, over 31°C.

SINGAPORE

Tougher rules on e-bike batteries

After 49 e-bike and scooter fires last year, Parliament debated a law making it an offence to fit the wrong battery, from 2027. Fines for illegal ride-hail drivers rise to S$10,000.

INDIA IN BRIEF

- **Interest rates:** The RBI raised its main rate to 5.50%, the first rise since 2023 (page 7).
- **Tamil Nadu heat:** The state is using near-record electricity; relief may come with the northeast monsoon around Oct 20.
- **Practice spaceship:** ISRO will build a sealed habitat in Bengaluru where 4 astronauts can live for 60 days.
- **Delhi:** Opposition MPs marched against the Chief Election Commissioner; police briefly detained some.

SINGAPORE & REGION IN BRIEF

- **Thailand:** Floods have killed 60 and affected 3.5 million people.
- **Myanmar:** Its coup leader got a red-carpet welcome in Malaysia, a big shift for ASEAN.
- **NTU satellite:** CRIMSON-1 is testing cheap perovskite solar cells in orbit.
- **Asian Games:** Singapore won 18 medals, 2 gold; India won 85, finishing 4th.

TAMIL CORNER

இடைத்தேர்தல்
(idaith-thērthal) = by-election. **இடை** = in between, **தேர்தல்** = election.

FESTIVAL COUNTDOWN

OCT 11–19
Navratri
Nine nights; kolu dolls on the steps.

OCT 20
Dussehra
Rama defeats Ravana.

NOV 8
Diwali
Lamps, rangoli, sweets.

Which kolu doll will you add?



MAYIL



WEATHER

Hurricane Isaias: latest first hurricane in 121 years

Isaias became the Atlantic's first hurricane of 2026 on Oct 7, the latest since 1905. A "super" **El Niño** made winds that tore storms apart.

With 100 mph winds, it was forecast to hit the Gulf Coast late Friday; Florida and Alabama declared emergencies.

SUPREME COURT

Nine justices, big questions

The Supreme Court's new term began Oct 5. Its first case asks whether towns can make **oil companies pay** for climate damage. Coming up: whether the Constitution protects owning AR-15-style rifles, whether Arizona can demand proof of citizenship to register to vote, and whether Colorado can leave Catholic preschools out of free pre-K.

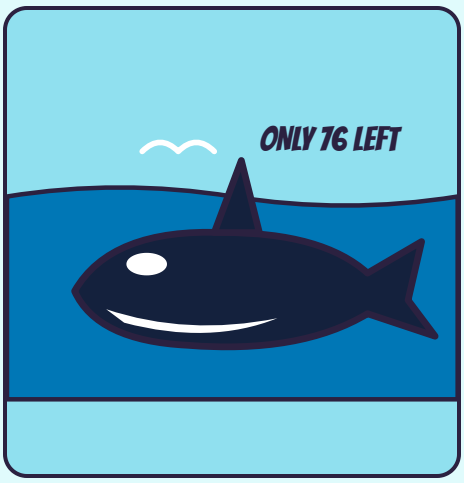
Decisions usually arrive by the end of June.

ELECTION: NOV 3

Midterms: who will control Congress?

Every House seat and a third of the Senate are up for election. Republicans hold narrow majorities in both (218 of 435 seats is a House majority). Democrats are campaigning on the Iran war and health costs; Republicans on lower taxes, border security and the economy. Polls say voters care most about the cost of living.

READ MORE



SALISH SEA

A sad week for our orcas

An orca mother called J31 was seen carrying her newborn calf, which had died, in the Strait of Juan de Fuca. Only **76** southern resident orcas remain. Their main food, Chinook salmon, is scarce, and ship noise and pollution make it harder.

SNOHOMISH COUNTY

Ballots in the mail

About 535,000 county voters get ballots by Oct 14. Statewide measures include **I-645** (would repeal the state's new tax on income over $1 million), a measure on who can play in girls' school sports, and one on parents' rights to review school materials. Voters also pick 5 of 9 state Supreme Court justices.

FERRIES

Ferries stopped by a sick-out

23 engineers called in sick on Oct 5, so 13 of 18 state ferries couldn't sail. Service returned the next day.

CLOSE TO HOME

Light rail to Everett: your say

Plans for 16 miles of light rail from Lynnwood to Everett include an **Ash Way** station near us. Comments close Nov 2; trains could run by 2037-2041.

READ MORE



PROF. HOOT

Ask: what's on our ballot this year?

ALSO IN THE NEWS

- **Jobs:** Only 29,000 US jobs were added in September.
- **Home from space:** Crew-12 splashed down after almost 8 months on the station.
- **Boeing:** Engineers approved a new contract with 34% raises over four years, avoiding a strike.

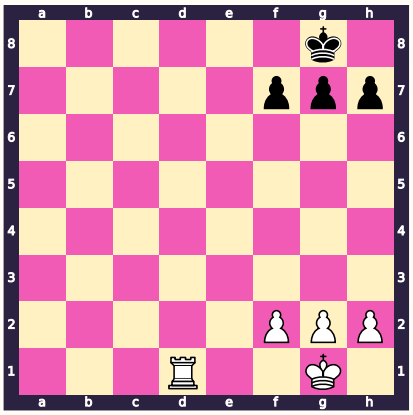
One sudoku, three checkmates

SUDOKU (TRICKY)

	5	2	9				4	
1				3				
9			5			7		1
		6			7			3
		7		8		2		
4			2			8		
5		1			9			7
				5				2
	3				2	5	8	

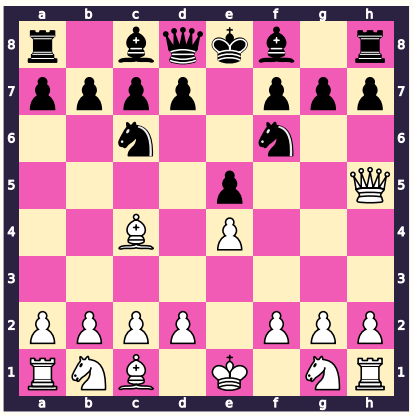
Fill every row, column and 3×3 box with 1 to 9. No repeats. Use a pencil!

1. White mates in 1



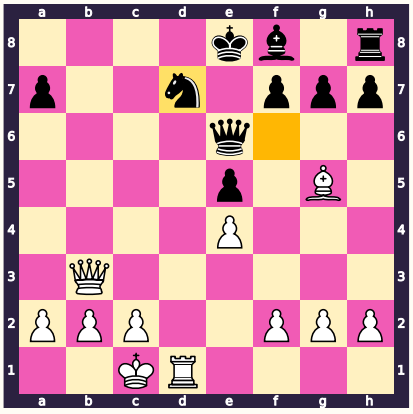
The back-rank trap

2. White mates in 1



Watch out for this one in your games!

3. White mates in 2



From the Opera Game (1858)



PROF. HOOT

Answers on page 12.
Try before you peek!

HOW TO WRITE A CHESS MOVE

- Letters a-h are columns, numbers 1-8 are rows. Pieces: K king, Q queen, R rook, B bishop, N knight.
- x means captures, + means check, # means checkmate. So Qxf7# = queen takes on f7, checkmate!

MAKE & THINK

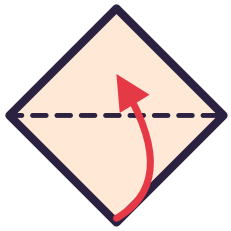
Fold a cup, crack a riddle, escape a maze

11

REAL!

ORIGAMI: A CUP THAT REALLY HOLDS WATER

1



Start with a square, coloured side down. Fold the bottom corner up to the top corner.

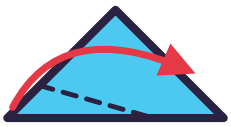
2



FOLD AT THE BOTTOM

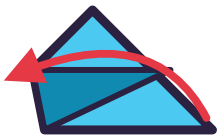
You have a triangle with the fold at the bottom.

3



Fold the left corner across so its tip touches the right edge. Keep the top edge flat.

4



Now fold the right corner across to the left edge the same way.

5



Fold the front top flap down over the front, tucking it in.

6

FLIP IT OVER!



Flip it over and fold the back flap down too.

7



Gently squeeze the sides to open your cup. Try a sip of water!

BRAIN TEASERS

1. A farmer has 17 sheep. All but 9 run away. How many are left?
2. A bat and a ball cost $1.10 together. The bat costs $1 more than the ball. How much is the ball?
3. What comes next? 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, ...
4. Mary's father has five daughters: Nana, Nene, Nini, Nono. What is the fifth one called?
5. How many times can you subtract 5 from 25?
6. You have a 3-litre jug and a 5-litre jug. How do you measure exactly 4 litres?

LOGIC PUZZLE

Asha, Ben and Chen each read a different section first (Science, World, Puzzles) and eat a different snack (murukku, apple, popcorn). Who reads what, and eats what?

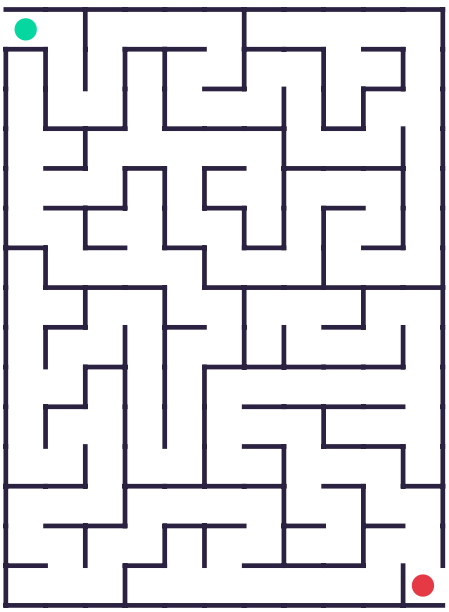
1. Asha does not read World first.
2. Whoever reads Puzzles first eats popcorn.
3. Ben eats murukku.
4. Chen reads Science first.

	Section	Snack
Asha		
Ben		
Chen		

Tip: start with the clue that tells you something for certain (clue 4), then use clue 1.

MAZE

Guide Loki the sea cucumber from the **green** dot down to the **red** canyon floor.





BOLT

Riddle 2 tricks most grown-ups. Test yours!

THE WEEKLY QUIZ

1 point each. 8+ = news genius!

1. **Which narrow sea lane carries about a fifth of the world's oil?**
   (a) Suez Canal (b) Strait of Hormuz
   (c) Strait of Malacca
2. **What is the difference between a ceasefire and a peace deal?**
3. **Why is Brazil holding a second round of voting on Oct 25?**
4. **About how many neutrinos pass through your body every second?**
   (a) 100 (b) 100 million (c) 100 trillion
5. **What does 'chirality' describe?**
6. **Why was the new fossil crocodile named after Egypt's god Heru?**
7. **What does 'alleged' mean in a news story?**
8. **What is inflation, in one sentence?**
9. **Where does the haze over Singapore come from?**
10. **How many southern resident orcas are left?**
    (a) 76 (b) 176 (c) 760

WORD SEARCH: THIS WEEK'S NEWS

O	A	R	T	E	M	I	S	E	O	G	G
R	A	N	O	B	E	L	I	G	M	K	S
C	H	U	L	I	T	O	H	E	O	B	M
A	P	Y	U	S	O	S	A	E	N	T	E
E	B	O	L	A	S	S	Z	A	S	P	F
V	A	E	F	E	R	V	E	D	O	T	B
L	N	E	U	T	R	I	N	O	O	Y	S
S	T	R	D	T	B	H	G	I	N	B	D
S	I	N	F	L	A	T	I	O	N	P	T
A	C	P	T	A	R	I	F	F	L	V	S
V	S	G	I	P	S	T	M	E	T	R	O
E	L	E	C	T	I	O	N	L	O	K	I

NEUTRINO · HAZE · ORCA · NOBEL · MONSOON · INFLATION · ELECTION · EBOLA · ARTEMIS · LOKI · TARIFF · METRO



PROF. HOOT

All the answers live on this page. Try first!

ANSWERS

1 QUIZ: Strait of Hormuz · **2** A ceasefire stops fighting for now; a peace deal settles the argument · **3** Nobody won more than half the votes · **4** 100 trillion · **5** Having left- and right-handed mirror forms · **6** Its rock came from the Sphinx, which Heru may have inspired · **7** Accused but not proven · **8** When prices of most things rise, so money buys less · **9** Peat fires in Sumatra and Kalimantan, Indonesia · **10** 76 · **11** TEASERS: 9 · **12** 5 cents · **13** 13 · **14** Mary · **15** Once (then it's 20) · **16** Fill the 5, pour into the 3 (2 left), empty the 3, pour the 2 in, refill the 5, top up the 3: **4** left · **17** LOGIC: Asha: Puzzles, popcorn. Ben: World, murukku. Chen: Science, apple · **18** CHESS: 1. Rd8# · **19** 2. Qxf7# · **20** 3. Qb8+! Nxb8 Rd8#

SUDOKU ANSWER (PAGE 10)

7	5	2	9	6	1	3	4	8
1	6	8	7	3	4	9	2	5
9	4	3	5	2	8	7	6	1
2	8	6	4	9	7	1	5	3
3	1	7	6	8	5	2	9	4
4	9	5	2	1	3	8	7	6
5	2	1	8	4	9	6	3	7
8	7	9	3	5	6	4	1	2
6	3	4	1	7	2	5	8	9

Red numbers are the ones you filled in.